

THE PLAYER-COACH PLAYBOOK

Getting Started

Set Up Your Season

Read this before Lesson 1. It takes about 10 minutes, and you only do it once.

M.V.P. Accelerator™

POWERED BY ATHLEADERSHIP ARENA™



Welcome to the Player-Coach's Corner

Welcome, Player-Coach.

The document you are holding is more than a workbook; it is your command center for this season. While your Athleader is in the arena conditioning their skills, this is your space for strategy, reflection, and growth. You are not just a spectator in their development; you are the most critical member of their coaching staff.

The M.V.P. Accelerator Player-Coach Track is designed with a dual purpose. It will equip you with the frameworks (like A.R.A.W.) and shared language to coach your Athleader through their journey effectively. But just as importantly, it is a dedicated space for you to condition your leadership muscles. We believe that to lead others effectively, you must first lead yourself well. The best coaches are also dedicated players, constantly sharpening their own skills.

Use this Playbook to translate the concepts from the videos into tangible actions. The drills within are designed to be practical, relevant, and immediately applicable to the real-world challenges you face as a leader, from driving team alignment and retaining top talent to managing your own energy and preventing burnout. This is your journey to becoming a more impactful, aligned, and resilient leader.

Use this space in this Playbook to reflect deeply, plan strategically, and commit to action. Right now, establish the time you will commit to make this a priority: block 45-60 minutes on your calendar each week (in one block or across multiple times) and schedule a meeting with yourself to ensure you don't allow anyone else to take this valuable time away from an investment in yourself. This is your journey. Own it.

You've got this!



Melissa Dawn Simkins
Founder, Athleadership, and Head Coach

Your role this season

Who is my Athleader?

The person you manage who is taking the Athleader track. You're their Player-Coach: you lead your own season and coach them through theirs.

Two roles, one season

Lead self, then lead others. Every lesson has one drill for your own leadership and one or two for coaching your Athleader and your team.

The shared language: A.R.A.W. (Core 4)

Your Athleader conditions the same four leadership muscles you do. Using the same words is half of coaching them.



Agility. My ability to adapt to change, pivot quickly, and make decisions under pressure.

Resilience. My ability to bounce back from setbacks, manage stress, and maintain a positive mindset.

Alignment. My ability to align my daily actions with my deeper purpose and values, and to communicate clearly with my team.

Wellbeing. My ability to manage my energy, prioritize recovery, and sustain high performance without burnout.

GETTING STARTED

How your Playbook works

Each lesson has its own Playbook file. You'll find it on the lesson's **Condition the Reps** screen, near the end of the lesson, and in the course's Resources list. The whole season is also available in one file, if you'd rather keep everything together. Pick one way and keep your answers in it.

Every lesson's pages follow the same order:

1. **Pre-Game Huddle.** The lesson's focus, its objectives, and where to start.
2. **A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills.** One core rep, marked "start here," and extra reps if you have time. Lead self first, then lead others. Each one shows about how long it takes.
3. **Locker Room Reflection.** The lesson's real-world challenge, your notes, and the feedback you asked for.

Your season at a glance

Lesson	Your core rep	Core	All reps
1 Suit Up: Your Leadership M.V.P.	1.4 Your Starting Line	30 min	50 min
2 The Leader's Scouting Report	2.4 Forward-looking feedback	20 min	60 min
3 The 90-Day Way Game Plan	3.2 Your 90-day game plan	20 min	50 min
4 Activate Your M.V.P. Under Pressure	4.4 The agility question	15 min	40 min
5 Play the Season	5.2 Your energy audit	15 min	55 min
6 The Victory Lap and the Next Season	6.3 Championship Conversation	30 min	60 min

About an hour a week: your lesson, then one core rep, often a conversation you would hold anyway. Extra reps are there when you have more time.

Filling it in

- Type straight into the grey boxes, and tick the boxes that apply.
- Save the file to keep your answers. In a browser, use the download or save button. In Acrobat or Preview, use Save.
- Prefer paper? Print the pages and write by hand.
- Only you see what you write. Nothing in this file is sent anywhere.

Your 90-Day Way Scorecard is a separate file, for your own 90-day leadership goal. You set it in Lesson 3 and track it week by week. It's in the course's Resources list.

GETTING STARTED

Set Up Your Season

Four things to do before Lesson 1. Check off each one as you complete it.

- [ ] **Take your Benchmark Pre-Assessment.** It takes about five minutes, in the course, and you take the same one at the end of your season.

- [ ] **Save your Playbook** somewhere you'll find it again: this file now, and each lesson's pages as you reach them.

- [ ] **Book the Starting Line with your Athleader.** Your first 30-minute conversation. You're the one who books it, ideally this week. Melissa's Commitment and Starting Line agenda is in the Resources list, and Drill 1.4 helps you prepare.

My Athleader: _____ Meeting date: _____

- [ ] **Block about an hour a week:** your lesson, then one core rep. Same time each week. Move it when you need to, as long as you keep it.

Day: _____ Time: _____

"I am a manager who manages several participants."

Great. This journey supports your growth and your team's. If you manage multiple participants, hold one 30-minute Starting Line with each person at the start. After that, build the 15-minute check-ins into your existing meeting rhythm. No need to create additional meetings.



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